



HANGOUTS

Introduced at Google I/O Developer's 2013 conference, Hangouts is a new instant messaging and video chatting platform developed by Google. Hangouts replaces the three previously developed services: Talk, Google+ Messenger and Google+ Hangouts, which is a video chat service available within Google's social network.

Let's quickly get started with our tips and tricks on Hangouts.

Minimum system requirements

Hangout runs on the major web browsers such as Google Chrome, Microsoft's Internet Explorer, Mozilla Firefox and Safari. You'll need to ensure the availability of an updated version of any of these web browsers running on your system. Hangout supports operating systems such as Mac OS X, Windows 7/Vista/XP, Chrome, Ubuntu and other Debian-based Linux distributions. You can have a group Hangout messaging session with up to 100 people at a time and a video call with up to 10 people at a time. For video calling on Hangouts, a broadband internet connection is necessary. For a smooth experience with Hangouts, make sure you have minimum upload speed of 1 Mbps and at least a 2 GHz dual core processor or greater running on your system.

Enable Hangouts in Gmail

Google rolled out Hangouts as a default instant messenger for Gmail and Google+. However, if you're still using the old XMPP (Extensible Messaging and Presence Protocol) based Google Talk from within your Gmail account and want to experience the new Hangouts messaging system, you can easily switch



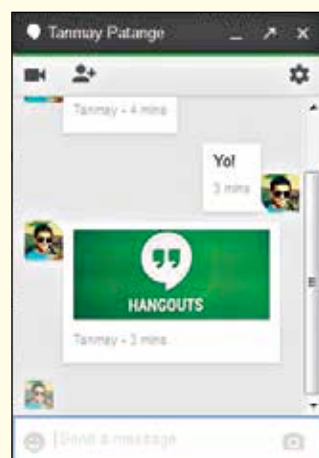
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with just a few clicks. All you have to do is click your profile photo at the top of your Chat list and select "Try the new Hangouts". Gmail will automatically refresh and you'll be able to start using Hangouts.



The Hangouts chat window

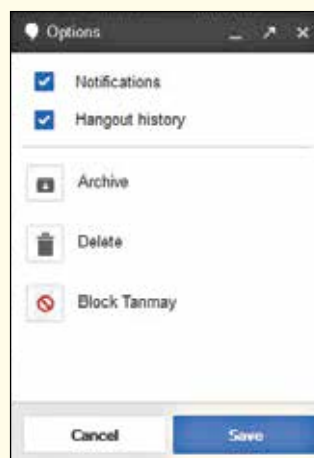
Disable Hangouts in Gmail

If you don't feel at home with Hangouts and want to stick to the old Google Talk interface within Gmail, you can easily revert to the old chat system. Just click your name or profile

picture again and select "Revert to old chat" from the dropdown list of options.

Turn on / off notifications

Do you want to get rid of all



Uncheck "Notifications" for each friend from the Options screen in the chat window

those notifications? Notifications settings in Hangouts are easily adjustable. While notifications in Hangouts are turned on by default, you can easily switch them off in case you don't want to be notified about activi-

ties of any specific person from your Hangouts list. Click the name of the person in the Hangouts list > Click the gear icon on the upper right of the chat window > Uncheck "Notifications" in the Hangouts Options screen that follows > Click "Save"

Turn on/off sound notifications

Sound notifications in Hangouts can be annoying, especially when you're busy working on some other tabs in your browser. Each time you receive new messages, especially one after another, the notification sound is capable enough to distract your busy mind from the task at hand. Like other notifications, sound notifications are also turned on by default. If you want to disable them, click your name and select "Mute sounds".

Snooze notifications

If you're worried that you'll miss an important update from friends for whom you've turned off notifications, there's a solution to put you at ease – snooze notifications. Find this option just above the "Mute sounds" option when you click your name. Once selected, it lets you determine how long you want to disable the Hangouts notifications for. When you turn on snooze notifications for a particular period, you won't be notified about any new messages or video calls. It's helpful for times when you don't want to be disturbed, as it minimises distractions.

Turn Hangouts history on/off

If you don't want chat history to be saved in your profile, you better turn it off. Once it's turned off, all incoming messages will only be visible in the Hangouts